

Responsible AI Use in Coding Rubric

Updated June 2026 for mobile readability and standards-review clarity.

Responsible AI Use in Coding Rubric

AI + Coding Starter Kit | Assessment Tool | Teachers / Students

Purpose: Use the rubric with a code artifact, bug log, short reflection, or student conference.

Standards summary: This resource may support Tennessee Computer Science Foundations standards when used as part of AI literacy, computer science, programming, digital ethics, or cybersecurity instruction.

Detailed standards connection appears at the end of this document.

Category

1 - Needs Support

2 - Developing

3 - Proficient

4 - Strong

Student Ownership

Student cannot explain
code or AI use.

Student explains some
code, but relies heavily
on AI output.

Student explains most
code and identifies AI
support.

Student clearly
explains code, choices,
AI support, and final
decisions.

Debugging Process

No clear
troubleshooting
process.

Some attempt to
identify or fix the issue.

Uses a basic debug
process and tests the
result.

Clearly identifies,
isolates, fixes, verifies,
and documents the
issue.

Prompt Quality

Prompt asks AI to
complete the task.

Prompt asks for broad
help with limited
student control.

Prompt asks for
explanation, hint, or

debugging support.
Prompt is specific,
ethical,
learning-focused, and
keeps student thinking
central.

Code Understanding

Student cannot
describe program
behavior.

Student describes
parts of the program
with gaps.

Student explains main
program behavior and
fix.

Student explains
program flow, bug
cause, fix, and possible
next improvement.

Verification

No testing or checking
is shown.

Limited testing or
unclear verification.

Student tests or traces
code after revision.

Student verifies the fix
and explains how the
result was confirmed.

Academic Integrity

AI appears to replace
student work.

AI use is unclear or
weakly documented.

AI use is documented
and generally
appropriate.

AI use is transparent,
appropriate, and
clearly supports
learning.

Teacher Notes

- Use the rubric with a code artifact, bug log, short reflection, or student conference.
- A working program should not receive full credit if the student cannot explain the code.
- AI use should be evaluated by purpose, transparency, and evidence of learning, not simply by whether AI was used.

Student AI Use Documentation

• Students can complete these statements when submitting AI-supported coding work:

• The coding problem I worked on was: _____

• The part I tried before using AI was: _____

B

AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code

1

• The AI prompt I used was: _____

AI helped me understand: _____

• The final code change I made was: _____

I verified the code by: _____

Conference Questions

What does this program do?

Where was the bug or challenge?

How did you decide what to change?

What did AI explain, and what did you still do yourself?

Could you solve a similar problem without AI next time?

B

AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code

2

Detailed Tennessee Standards Connection

This rubric supports standards when students document debugging, explain programming decisions, verify results, and evaluate whether AI use was ethical and learning-focused.

Standards source: Tennessee Department of Education, Computer Science Foundations (C10H11), May 2023. Confirm final alignment against local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.

This resource may support the following Tennessee standards when used as part of AI literacy, computer science, programming, digital ethics, or cybersecurity instruction:

• CSF 9.2 - Troubleshooting Process: Students use a structured process to identify a problem, gather information, isolate causes, test a solution, verify the result, and document what they learned.

• CSF 13.1 - Social, Legal, and Ethical Issues: Students identify responsibilities related to ethical technology use, academic integrity, copyright, appropriate AI use, and responsible programming support.

• CSF 16.1 - Programming Language: Students explore programming languages such as Python and explain how programmers use them to solve a variety of IT problems.

• CSF 16.2 - Software Development Life Cycle: Students connect planning, coding, testing, refinement, deployment, and maintenance to an iterative software-development process.

Purpose

Use this rubric to evaluate student coding work when AI support is allowed. The goal is to assess both programming understanding and responsible AI use.

Rubric

Cautious guidance: Alignment depends on local district pacing, approved course placement, teacher directions, and how the resource is used as part of instruction.

B

AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code
3

B
AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code
4

B
AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code
4

Standards Review Standards review note (June 2026): Tennessee Computer Science Foundations course standards (C10H11) remain published by the Tennessee Department of Education as May 2023 standards. Standards references in this resource are intended as cautious instructional alignment notes; final alignment should be confirmed against local district pacing, course placement, and current district guidance.